ltrim(), rtrim(), trim()

These three functions are self-explanatory: `ltrim()` removes bytes from the beginning of a string, `rtrim()` does the same but from the end, and `trim()` does both ends at once (which saves having to call `rtrim(ltrim($string));`). The default byte values that will be removed are the usual suspects: form-feed, horizontal tab, vertical tab, line-feed, carriage-return, and also the null byte *0x00*.

```
$padLeft = "\t\r\n\v text";
$padRight = "text\x00\t\r\n\v ";

print ltrim($padLeft) . PHP_EOL;
print strlen(rtrim($padRight));

Output:
text
4
```

Pretty straightforward stuff. The functions can also be used to strip any other bytes (ASCII characters or hexadecimal escapes, as you prefer):

```
print (ltrim('aaabbbcccThe text we care about', 'abc')) . PHP_EOL;
print (rtrim('Also the text we care aboutzzzzzzxxxy', 'xyz')) . PHP_EOL;
print (trim('aabbcczzAnd this text tooxxxyyzzzaaa', 'abcxyz'));

Output:
The text we care about
Also the text we care about
And this text too
```

Unsophisticated but surprisingly handy and used just about everywhere. Be aware that `rtrim()` also has an alias, `chop()`, which might be found in the wild from time to time. These three functions are safe to use on UTF-8 data but will break any other Unicode transfer format due to the null byte stripping.

mb_ltrim(), mb_rtrim(), mb_trim()

A new addition for PHP 8.4, this trio of functions works just like their core counterparts (with the added benefit of multibyte safety, of course). They also greatly extend the range of default characters that will be stripped from the edges. In addition to `"\f\n\r\t\v"`, these functions will strip: